

UNIT 1 · LESSON 6

I Can Change and Grow

20–25 min · Week 6

OBJECTIVE Students articulate that they have grown since the start of the year and identify one specific way they have changed.

CASEL FOCUS Self-Awareness · recognising growth; identifying capacity for change

VOCABULARY grow · change · before · now · practice · better at · still learning

MATERIALS Sammy puppet · Then-and-Now drawing paper · crayons · optional photos from start of year

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES K-2 · EARLY ELEMENTARY**Goal 1 — Self-Awareness & Self-Management**

1B.1a Identify one's likes and dislikes, needs and wants, strengths and challenges.

1C.1b Identify goals for academic success and classroom behavior.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

OPENING REVIEW · 1 – 2 MIN

Show the Mistake Wall and the Oops vs. I Am Bad chart. "We have learned a lot together. Today we are going to look back and see how much we have grown."

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"When I started this year, I did not know how to do a lot of things. Now I can do some of them! I am still learning others. That is what GROWING is."

► DIRECT INSTRUCTION

Scripted teaching sequence · 4 STEPS · read aloud or in your own words

01 What Is Growing?

4 MIN

Define growing simply: "Growing means — you can do something now that you could not do before. You learned. You practised. You got better at it. You are still YOU — you just have more skills, more words, more ways to handle hard things."

02 Sammy's Story

5 MIN

Sammy shares a small growth story: "When I started this year, I used to say 'I AM bad' when I made a mistake. Now I say 'I made an OOPS — I can fix it.' I am still learning! But I have GROWN."

Sammy: *"What is something you used to find hard — that is easier now?"*

03 Then-and-Now Drawing

12 MIN

Students fold paper in half. On the BEFORE side: draw something that used to feel hard or scary. On the NOW side: draw the same thing — but with how they handle it now. Optional: add a Kind Coach speech bubble showing what they say to themselves now. See the polished Drawing Activity reference.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Students who cannot identify any growth may be feeling stuck. Crouch down warmly: "Even noticing one tiny thing counts. Want me to help?" Do not pressure.

04 Share Circle

4 MIN

Voluntary share. Each student who wants to holds up their drawing and describes ONE thing that has changed. Sammy responds warmly to each share. Land: "Growing is small — and real."

KINDERGARTEN

Stay with simple before/now contrast. Stick figures and one-word labels are perfect. The act of noticing one growth moment is the lesson.

GRADES 1 – 2

Students add a sentence below each drawing: "Before, I..." / "Now, I..." Discuss: what helped you change? Was it practice? A safe adult? Time?

EXIT TICKET

"Hold up your drawing if you found one way you have grown. Sammy bows to each held-up drawing."

Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled to identify any growth? These students may be carrying a fixed sense of self. Pair them with growth-focused responses going forward.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student whose BEFORE drawing depicts something concerning — a real hurt, an ongoing situation — should be noted for counselor follow-up.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

A Note Home

Today we celebrated growth. At home, share with your child one way YOU have grown this year — something you used to find hard that is easier now. Modelling growth makes it visible.

DRAWING ACTIVITY · UNIT 1 · LESSON
6

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

UNIT 1 · LESSON 6 · DRAWING ACTIVITY 2

Then-and-Now Drawing

Students fold paper in half — BEFORE and NOW sides

GROWTH STORY

This drawing celebrates growth. The same situation — drawn twice — shows how far a student has come.

BEFORE



felt hard or scary

NOW



handles it now

Simple stick figures are perfect — the contrast is the point.

— STEP-BY-STEP STUDENT INSTRUCTIONS —

1
FOLD

Students fold paper in half — two panels side by side.

2
BEFORE

On the BEFORE side, draw something that *used to feel* hard or scary.

3
NOW

On the NOW side, draw the same situation — but with how they handle it now.

4
LABEL

Label each side: BEFORE and NOW.

5
OPTIONAL

Optional: add a speech bubble showing what their Kind Coach says.

PRIVACY PROTOCOL

Display with student permission only. Never require a student to show their BEFORE side publicly.

TEACHER NOTE

This drawing celebrates growth. It pairs perfectly with the Oops → Fix It → Try Again anchor chart.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 1 · The Foundation (K–2)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

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